

the development of our long-awaited feature, the Universal Charging Solution (UCS).

As of now, the list of companies who have agreed to collaborate and work on the platform include the likes of Nokia, Sony Ericsson, Motorola, LG, Samsung and Vodafone.

Apparently the move has major ecological benefits, but for the end user, the real benefit is quite evident: a common format to charge your phone means that your Samsung charger would be completely compatible with your friend's Motorola handset.

The GSMA has suggested that the microUSB would, in all probability, be the common universal charging interface – a welcome move, considering the format's popularity and the upcoming launch of USB 3.0 devices that are faster at transferring electricity.

But with so many big names, does it not sound like a far-fetched dream that will have many roadblocks and be realised only by the time we rely on a walking stick? Not if GSMA has any say in it: The industry body has cracked the whip and set a deadline for itself: By January 1, 2012, a majority of phones will be compatible with the standard, they say. We wait with bated breath...

3.5 - 4G

The new generation of touchscreen mobile phones, such as the HTC Touch HD, has been increasing the resolution of the LCD display exponentially – 800x480 pixels on a cell phone is a huge number, when you consider that a lot of monitors today are still running at 1280x720 pixels. And with LG and Samsung showing prototypes of 720p screens and talking about fullHD, it's only a matter of time before your mobile phone was a complete portable media player.

On the other end, devices like the Samsung Omnia HD have brought in high-definition 720p video shooting to the tiny world of cell phones.

Now, what would be the point of such HD capabilities on these mobile devices if you could not harness their full potential while being mobile? Sure, they are fitted with up to 16GB of memory, but the point of a wireless device is